RentEase Kenya

User Training Manual

A Complete Guide for Landlords & Tenants

Version 1.0
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School of Technology — Final Year Project II

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1. Introduction

RentEase Kenya is a mobile-first rental management platform designed for small landlords and tenants in Kenya. It simplifies property management, rent collection via M-Pesa, maintenance tracking, and tenant communication.

This manual provides step-by-step instructions for both Landlords and Tenants. Screenshots from the live application are included to guide you through each feature.

Target Audience: Property owners (Landlords) managing 1–50 rental units, and their Tenants who need to pay rent and submit maintenance requests.

2. System Requirements

RentEase runs in any modern web browser. No installation is required — it works on phones, tablets, and computers.

1. A smartphone, tablet, or computer with internet access
2. Google Chrome, Safari, Firefox, or Edge browser
3. An active email address for account registration
4. An M-Pesa-registered phone number (for mobile payments)

Tip: You can install RentEase as a Progressive Web App (PWA) on your phone for quick access. Look for the “Add to Home Screen” banner when you first visit the app.

3. Getting Started

3.1 Creating an Account

To use RentEase, you must first create an account. During registration, you choose your role — Landlord or Tenant.

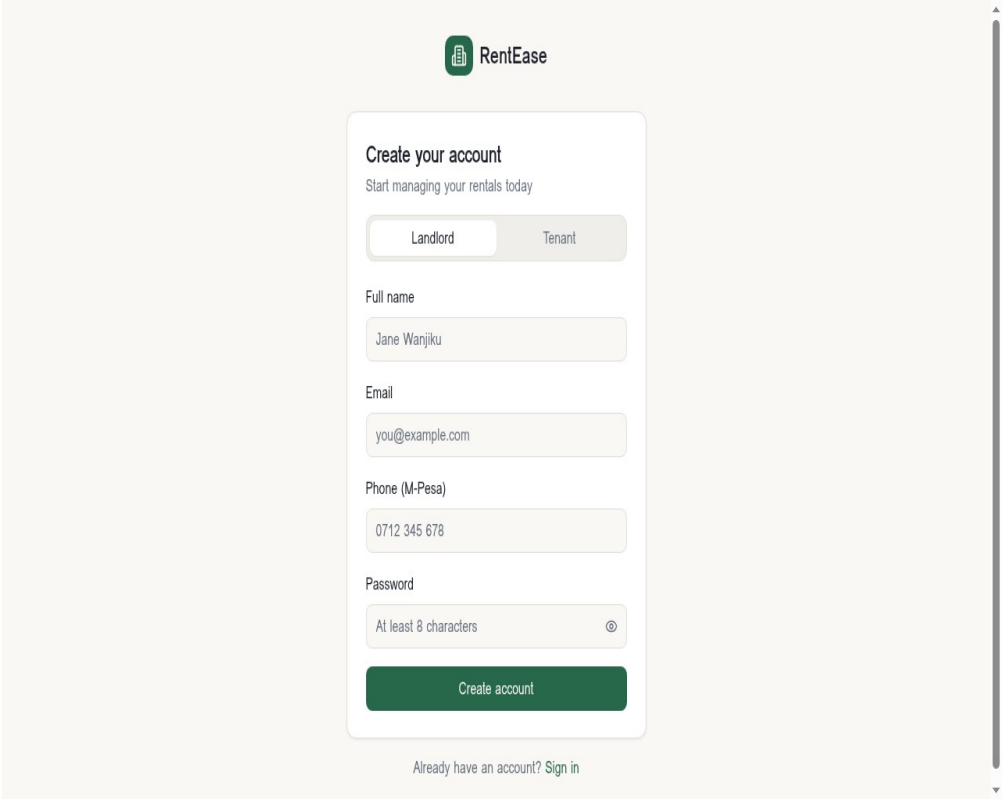

Figure 3.1: The Sign Up page with role selection (Landlord/Tenant)

1. Visit the RentEase application URL in your browser
2. Click “Sign up” on the login page
3. Select your role: Landlord or Tenant
4. Enter your full name, email, phone number, and a strong password
5. Click “Create account”
6. Check your email inbox and verify your email address
7. Once verified, sign in with your credentials

3.2 Logging In

After creating your account, use the login page to access the system.

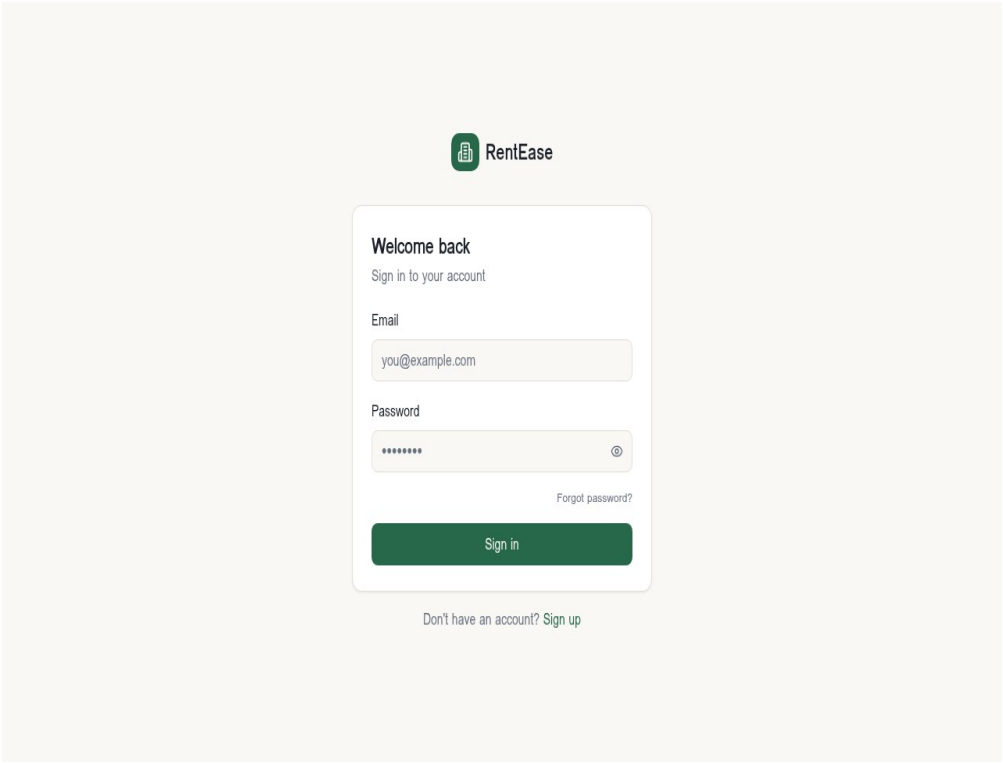

Figure 3.2: The Login page

1. Enter your registered email address
2. Enter your password
3. Click “Sign in”
4. You will be directed to the Dashboard (Landlord) or Tenant Portal (Tenant)

If you forget your password, click “Forgot password?” to receive a password reset email.

PART A

Landlord Manual

4.1 Dashboard Overview

The Dashboard is your home screen after logging in. It provides a quick summary of your rental portfolio at a glance.

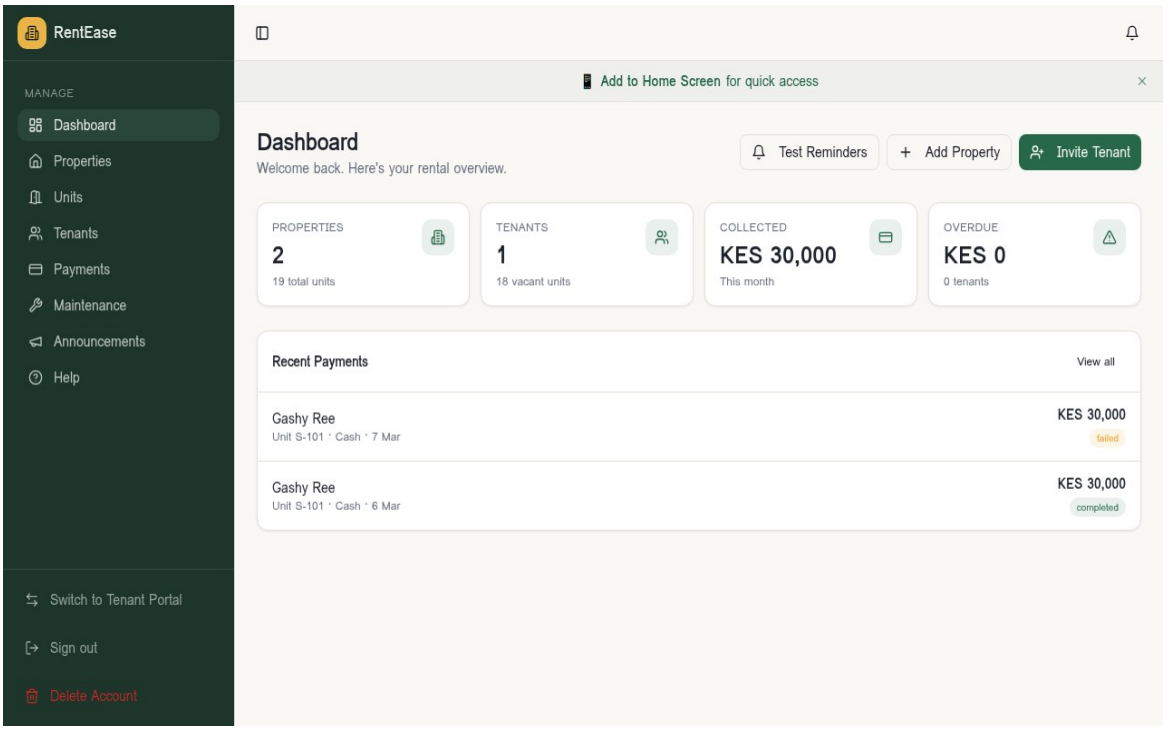

Figure 4.1: The Landlord Dashboard

The Dashboard shows four key statistics:

1. Properties — Number of rental properties and total units
2. Tenants — Number of occupied units and vacant units
3. Collected — Total rent collected this month (KES)
4. Overdue — Total overdue rent and number of tenants who haven't paid

Below the stats, you'll see your most recent payments with tenant name, unit, amount, payment method, and status.

Quick Actions: Use the buttons at the top right to Add Property, Invite Tenant, or Test Reminders.

4.2 Managing Properties

Properties are the buildings or plots where your rental units are located. You must add at least one property before creating units.

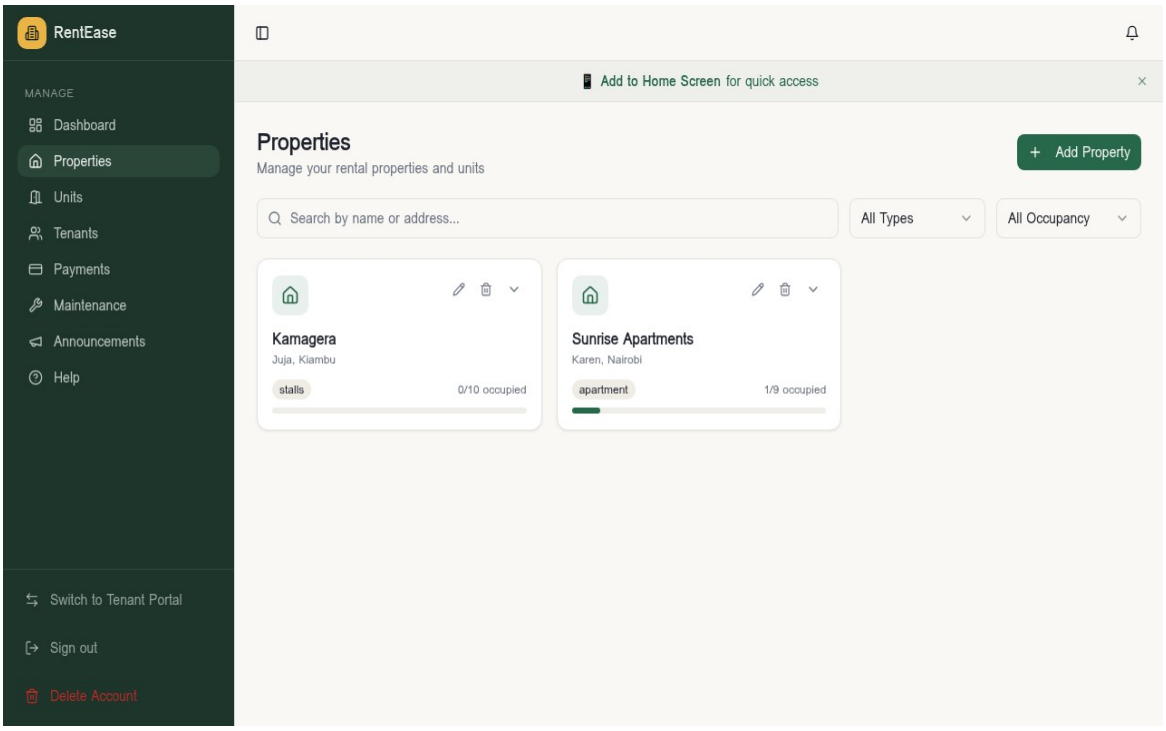

Figure 4.2: The Properties page showing property cards

Adding a New Property

1. Navigate to Properties from the sidebar
2. Click “+ Add Property” in the top right
3. Enter the property name (e.g., “Sunrise Apartments”)
4. Enter the address/location
5. Select the property type (Apartment, House, Stalls, etc.)
6. Enter the total number of units
7. Click “Save”

Editing or Deleting a Property

Each property card has edit (pencil) and delete (trash) icons. Click the pencil to update details, or the trash icon to remove a property. Note: Deleting a property will also remove all its units.

4.3 Managing Units

Units are the individual rental spaces within a property (e.g., Room 101, Stall A3). The Units page gives you a centralized view of all units across all properties.

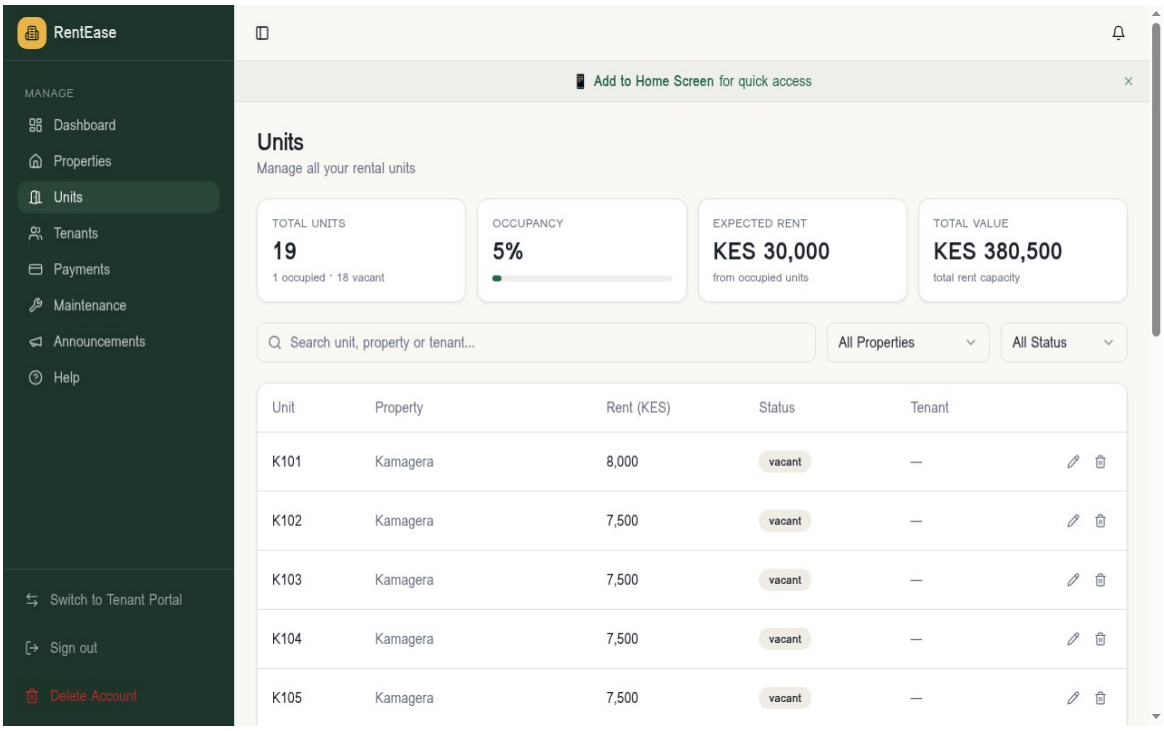

Figure 4.3: The Units page with occupancy stats and unit table

At the top, you can see summary statistics:

1. Total Units — Count of all units across properties
2. Occupancy — Percentage of occupied units
3. Expected Rent — Monthly rent from occupied units
4. Total Value — Total rent capacity if fully occupied

Use the search bar and filters to find specific units by name, property, or status (occupied/vacant).

Editing a Unit

Click the pencil icon next to any unit to update its details (unit number, rent amount, status). Click the trash icon to delete a unit.

4.4 Managing Tenants

The Tenants page allows you to manage your tenants and send invitations to new tenants.

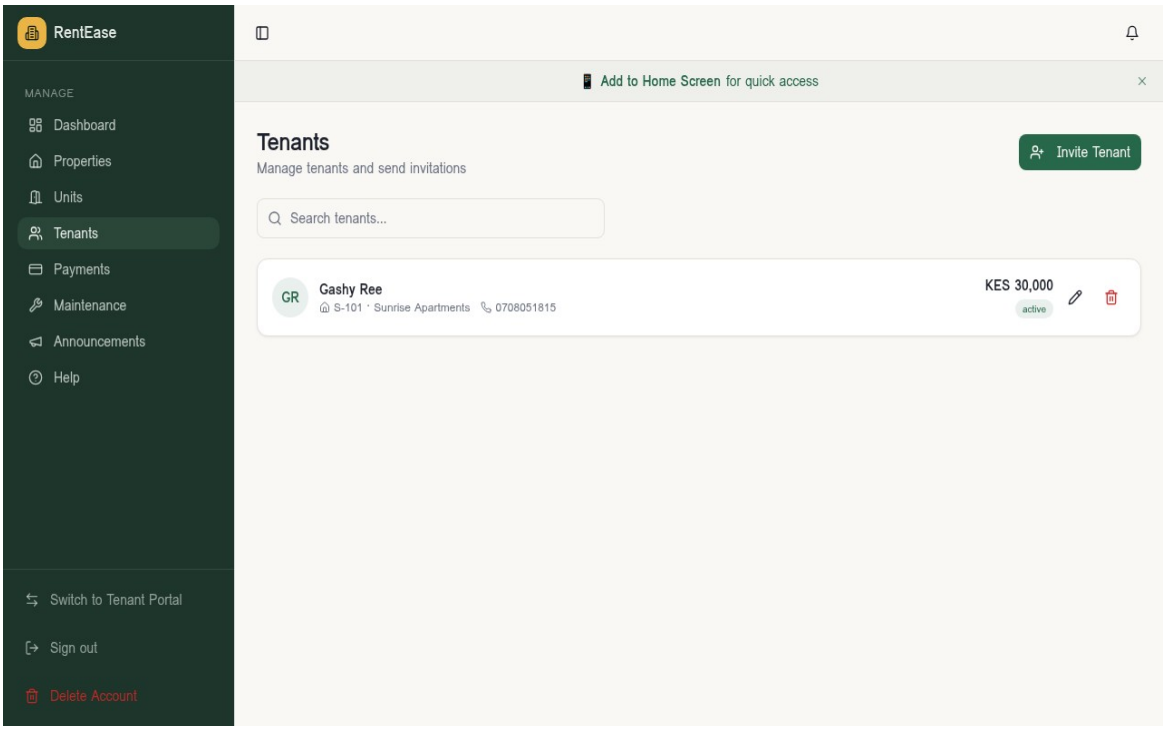

Figure 4.4: The Tenants page showing active tenants

Inviting a New Tenant

1. Click “Invite Tenant” in the top right corner
2. Enter the tenant’s name, email address, and phone number
3. Select the unit to assign them to
4. Click “Send Invitation”
5. The tenant will receive an email with a link to create their account and accept the invitation
6. Once accepted, the unit status changes to “occupied” automatically

You can also edit tenant details or remove a tenant from a unit using the action icons.

4.5 Payment Tracking

The Payments page lets you track all rent payments — both M-Pesa and cash.

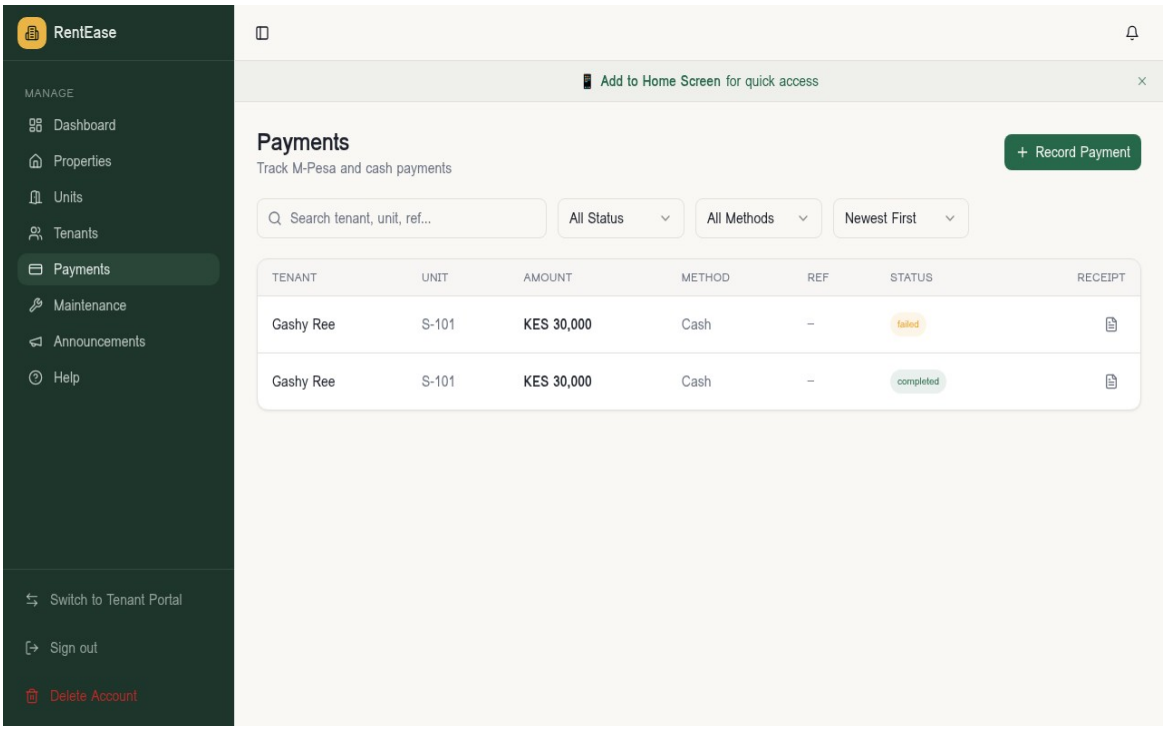

Figure 4.5: The Payments page with filters and payment records

Recording a Cash Payment

1. Click “+ Record Payment”
2. Select the tenant and unit
3. Enter the amount paid
4. Select “Cash” as the payment method
5. Click “Save”

M-Pesa payments are tracked automatically when tenants pay through the Tenant Portal. The status will show as “completed” or “failed”.

Receipts: Click the receipt icon next to any payment to view or download a payment receipt.

4.6 Maintenance Requests

Tenants can submit repair requests through their portal. As a landlord, you manage these from the Maintenance page.

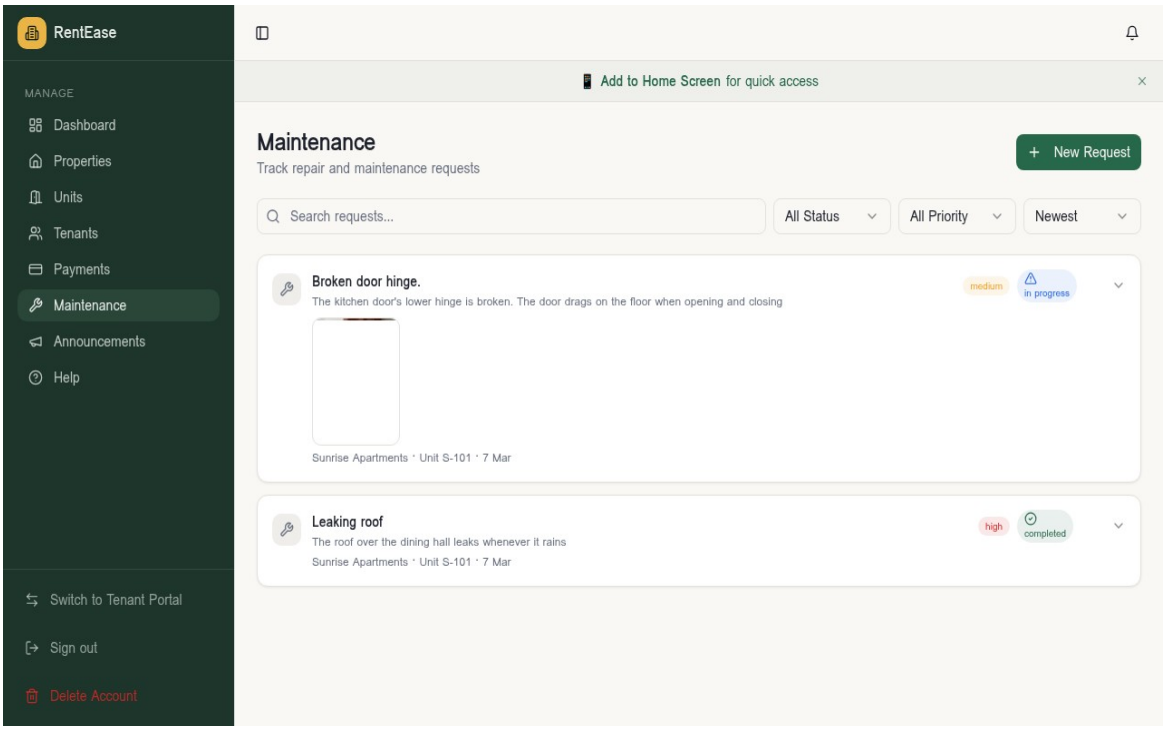

Figure 4.6: The Maintenance page with repair requests

Managing Requests

1. View all maintenance requests sorted by newest first
2. Filter by status (Open, In Progress, Completed) or priority (Low, Medium, High)
3. Click the dropdown arrow on any request to change its status
4. Tenants can attach photos to help describe the issue
5. The landlord receives an email notification when a new request is submitted

4.7 Announcements

Use the Announcements page to broadcast messages to all your tenants or to tenants of a specific property.

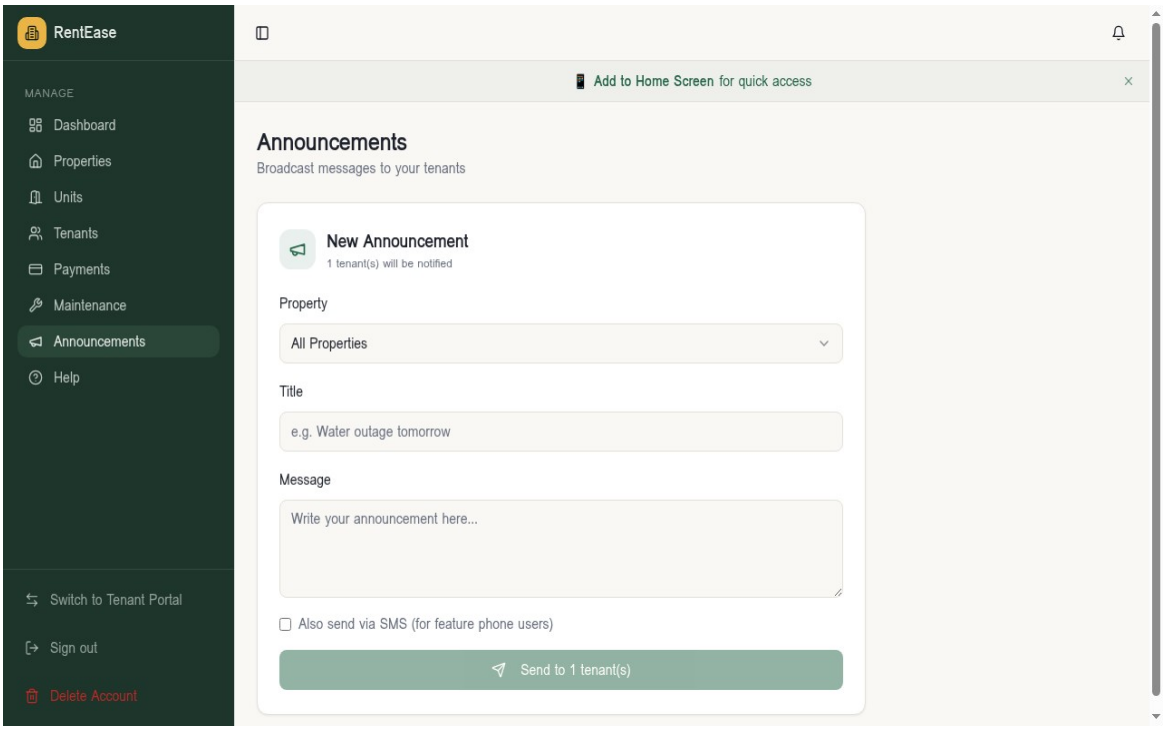

Figure 4.7: The Announcements page

1. Select the target property (or “All Properties”)
2. Enter a title (e.g., “Water outage tomorrow”)
3. Write your message
4. Optionally check “Also send via SMS” for feature phone users
5. Click “Send” — tenants will receive in-app notifications immediately

4.8 Notifications & Rent Reminders

RentEase includes an automated rent reminder system that sends notifications to tenants who haven't paid.

Reminders are sent automatically on these days each month:

1. 28th/29th — "Rent Due Soon" reminder (3 days before)
2. 1st — "Rent Due Today" notification
3. 5th — "Rent Overdue" warning

Reminders are delivered via in-app notifications. If Africa's Talking SMS is configured, tenants also receive SMS messages.

Test Reminders: Use the "Test Reminders" button on the Dashboard to manually trigger reminders and verify they're working.

Notification Bell: The bell icon in the top right shows unread notifications. Click it to view and mark notifications as read.

4.9 Help & Support

Click “Help” in the sidebar to access the built-in User Manual. The manual is role-aware — landlords see landlord-specific guides.

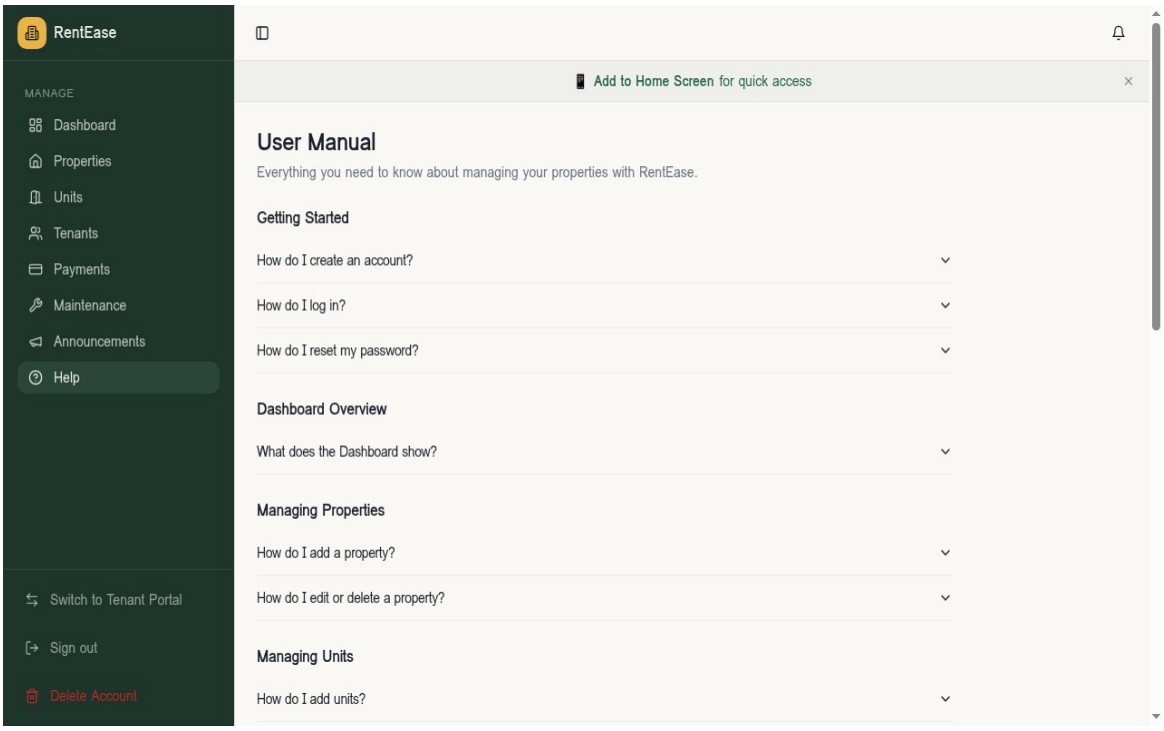

Figure 4.9: The Landlord Help page

4.10 Account Management

Signing Out

Click “Sign out” at the bottom of the sidebar to log out of your account.

Deleting Your Account

If you need to permanently delete your account and all associated data:

1. Click “Delete Account” (in red) at the very bottom of the sidebar
2. A confirmation dialog will appear
3. Type “DELETE” in the text field to confirm
4. Click the delete button
5. Your account, all properties, units, tenants, payments, and data will be permanently removed

⚠ Warning: This action is irreversible. Make sure to export any data you need before deleting your account.

PART B
Tenant Manual

5.1 Tenant Portal Overview

After logging in as a tenant, you'll see the Tenant Portal — your one-stop dashboard for managing your rental unit.

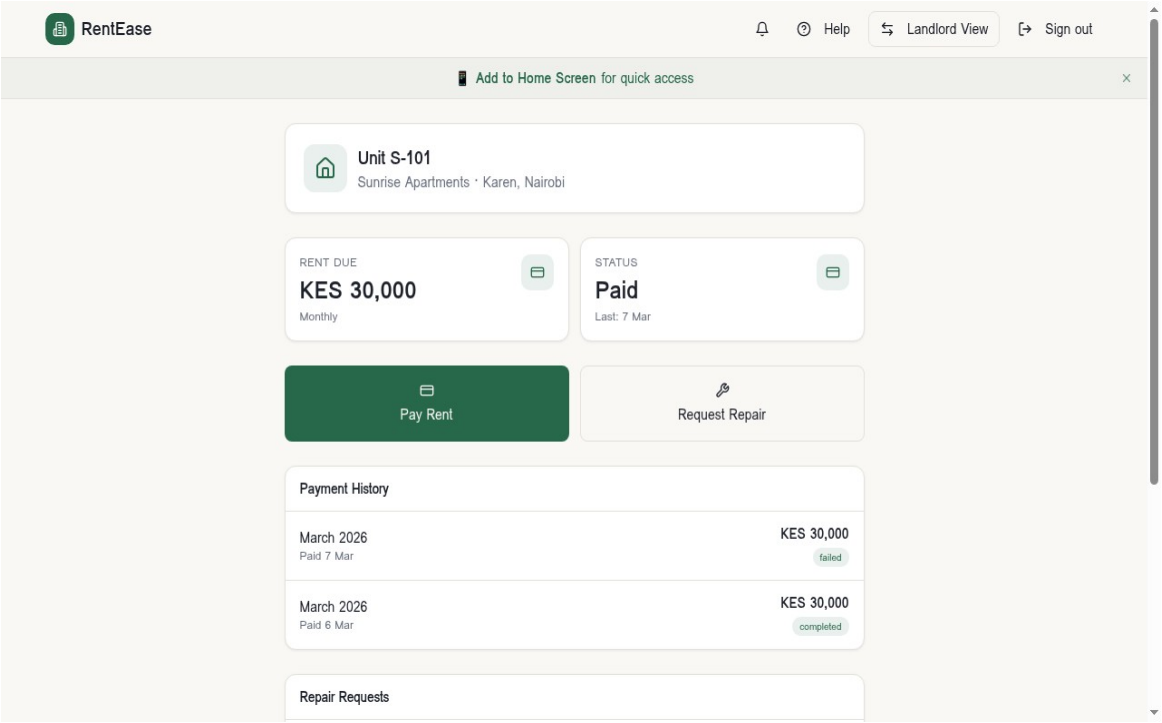

Figure 5.1: The Tenant Portal

The Tenant Portal shows:

1. Your unit information (unit number, property name, location)
2. Rent Due — Your monthly rent amount
3. Status — Whether your rent is paid for the current month
4. Pay Rent — Button to initiate M-Pesa payment
5. Request Repair — Button to submit a maintenance request
6. Payment History — All your past payments with dates and status
7. Repair Requests — Your submitted maintenance requests and their status

5.2 Paying Rent via M-Pesa

RentEase integrates with M-Pesa STK Push for seamless rent payment.

How to Pay

1. On the Tenant Portal, click the green “Pay Rent” button
2. Your phone number (registered with M-Pesa) will be pre-filled
3. Confirm the amount and click “Pay”
4. You will receive an M-Pesa STK push notification on your phone
5. Enter your M-Pesa PIN to authorize the payment
6. Wait for confirmation — the payment status will update to “completed”
7. Your landlord is automatically notified of the payment

If the payment fails, check your M-Pesa balance and try again. Your landlord can also record cash payments on your behalf.

5.3 Submitting Repair Requests

If something in your unit needs repair, you can submit a request directly through RentEase.

1. Click “Request Repair” on the Tenant Portal
2. Enter a title describing the issue (e.g., “Leaking faucet”)
3. Add a detailed description of the problem
4. Select the priority level (Low, Medium, High)
5. Optionally attach a photo showing the issue
6. Click “Submit”
7. Your landlord will be notified by email
8. Track the status of your request in the “Repair Requests” section

5.4 Viewing Notifications

Click the bell icon in the top right to view your notifications. You’ll receive notifications for:

1. Rent reminders (upcoming, due today, overdue)
2. Announcements from your landlord
3. Updates on your maintenance requests

Unread notifications are shown with a red badge on the bell icon. Click a notification to mark it as read.

5.5 Help & Support

Click “Help” in the top navigation bar to access the Tenant Guide. It covers:

1. How to create an account and log in
2. How to use the Tenant Portal
3. How to pay rent via M-Pesa
4. How to submit and track repair requests
5. How to view notifications

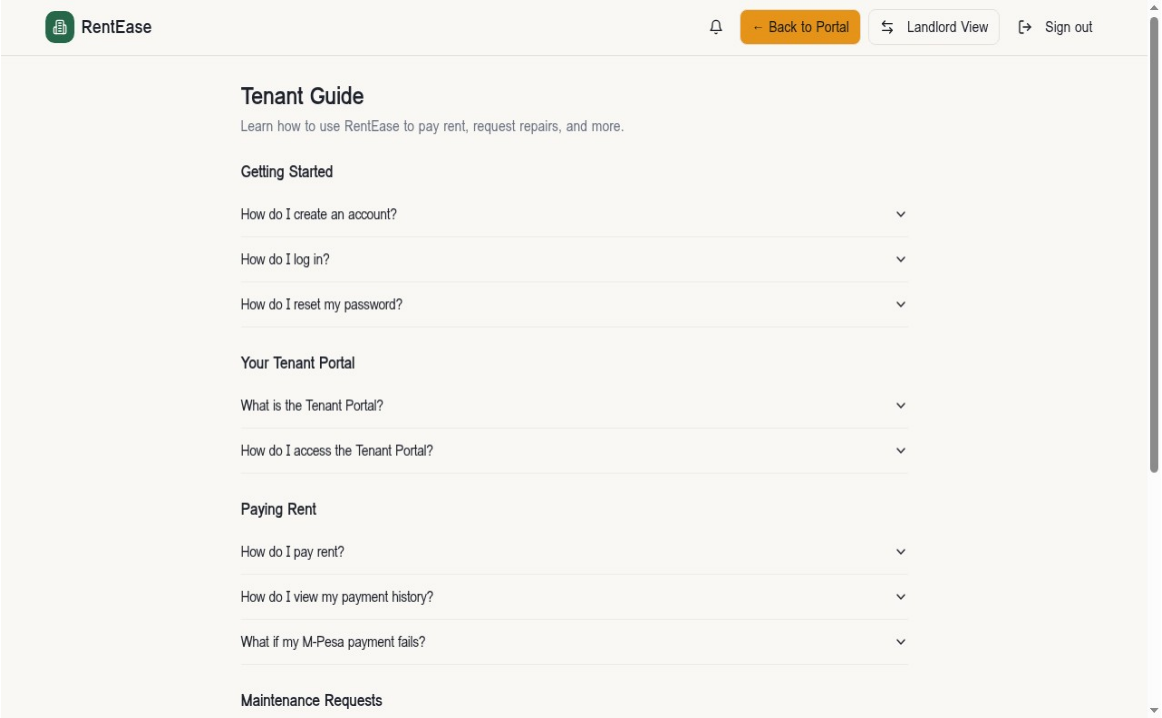

Figure 5.5: The Tenant Help page

Glossary

M-Pesa: Mobile money service by Safaricom used for cashless payments in Kenya.

STK Push: A prompt sent to your phone by M-Pesa to authorize a payment.

PWA: Progressive Web App — a web application that can be installed on your phone like a native app.

KES: Kenyan Shilling — the currency used in all payment amounts.

RLS: Row Level Security — database security that ensures users can only access their own data.

Dashboard: The main overview page showing key statistics and recent activity.

Tenant Portal: The dedicated interface for tenants to pay rent, request repairs, and view notifications.